

VOLUMES

ISSUE 7

KCB PRESENTS

readME

GOES TO

CARNIVAL



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Eshaan Joshi

A Freshman's Guide to Carnival

alternative where athleticism is completely optional.

Spending too much time outside is dangerous for CMU students, so Carnival also provides a wide array of indoor activities to enjoy. Head over to Hunt Library and enjoy the “Room to Imagine”, a showcase of 125 ways that CMU history can circle back to Andy Warhol. There’s also a Carnival Activities Tent, the perfect spot for a meet-cute with that handsome alumnus fifteen years older than you. Go for it, girl!

You and I have one thing in common: We've both never been to Spring Carnival. Fear not, because my expert sleuthing over the past few days has allowed me to gain insight into this mysterious campus-wide event. What does a midway taste like? Who's in the doghouse? I'll answer all your questions and more in the guide below!

Spring Carnival came to be when CMU administration realized that the student body may revolt without bread and circuses. Hence the tradition of selling snacks so unhealthy they make Stack'd Underground look like a dietician's haven. The rest of Carnival's events grew out of this singular focus: to let the CMU student be happy, if only for a moment. It's why Booth is such a popular event: Oh, the fulfillment of constructing a building instead of bombing it down!

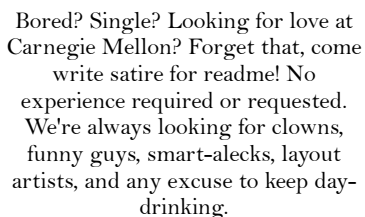
Buggy, another crowd favorite, draws from the CMU student's innate desire for physical affection. Nothing says "love" to a touch-starved college student like being stuffed into a tiny metal tube and dropped down a steep hill. Truly a heartwarming way to spend your mornings at Carnival!

If Buggy and Booth are too mainstream for you, there are always alternatives. Doghouse, a smaller form of booth, allows students insecure about their size to feel a little bit better about themselves. And for those with too much cowardice to risk life and limb in Buggy, Mobot provides a CS student-friendly

Now, I'd mention the various rides and games at Carnival, including the massive Ferris wheel that they lug onto campus somehow, but real CMU students have better, more productive ways to engage in risk. This includes Day Drinking, a fun event where students drink during the day. This is accompanied by Day Partying, both of which actually last well into the night!

Despite this, it's important to stay safe. That's why you should NOT attend the Fetty Wap concert on Saturday night. I heard he's been in jail or something. Also, make sure to always hold the dorm doors open for random strangers walking behind you. If you don't, they might get mad and yell at you, so it's definitely safer to let them in.

Have fun at Carnival, and remember this: Everything going wrong in your life doesn't have to exist for just this one weekend. Your taxes are filed, your summer job is locked in, and your finals are ages away. This is the one fun thing that happens at CMU, so you might as well enjoy it.

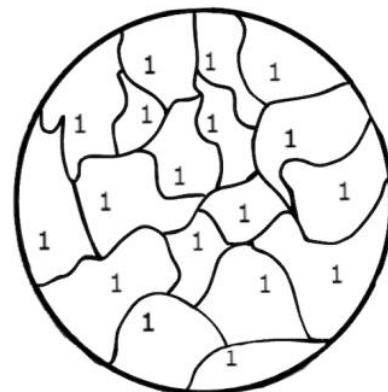


We're looking for you and your skills, or lack thereof, Saturdays at 5 in DH1211

readME
Booth Color by Numbers

- Topologist reveals Ferris wheel to be dodecahedron all along.
- Hardest job imaginable: affirming therapist to drone strike today.
- CUC gym administrators remove all first-floor machines to make space for a merchandise sweatshop.
- Alumni find 50% of soul returns after donating to Readme (cmureadme.com/donate).
- Wild Blue opens as gas station food for buggy repair depot.
- How to tell if your ice sculptures are ethically sourced.
- Repeatedly saying "No hablo ingles" has not helped me get out of my Spanish final.
- Local gnome discovers his house has been stolen by SDC booth.
- Opinions: Dishwashers are the LLMs of the household appliance world.
- Tired of protein shakes? Gym bros invent "carb shakes" comprised of beer, ground pasta, and soft-serve ice cream.
- Artemis 2's local Claude instance hallucinates, makes a call to the `"blow_up_ship_violently_with_cameras_watching"` API.

All this and more, not in this issue!



Key

1 = Yellow, 2 = Blue, 3 = Red, 4 = Green, 5 = Orange, 6 = Purple, 7 = Pink, 8 = Brown, 9 = Grey, 10 = Black

On my time working in the Allegheny cannon factory

Meat the Intern
Driven to Succeed

Back in 2023, I got this lucrative job working at the cannon factory down the street from the old abandoned steel mill (the very same steel mill I had my first kiss in eight years ago). They would pay me to come in every day, no matter the rain, sleet, snow, or hail, nor the birthdays, baseball games, or religious demonstrations, all just to sit in this dirty old cannon for two hours at a time. They were real particular about those hours too. On Sundays it was 7-9 AM, on Mondays 2-4 PM, Tuesdays 3-5 in the glassy-eyed hours of morning, and so on. Say what you will, but the pay was good, and man, the health insurance coverage was unbeatable. I could've broken every bone in my body or knocked out every last tooth in some freak accident, and I still wouldn't have paid a penny.

After so much time spent inside the barrel of a cannon, nowhere else to look but out the shaft, through the hole in the roof, and right out into the sky, the mind starts to play its tricks on you. It was always on those late Tuesday shifts that I could swear I was hearing footsteps creep up to the cannon, and as they did, the faint crackling sound of a fire would get a little louder. I might've even sworn I saw the iron inner walls of the cannon take on the faint orange glow of a flame. Nonetheless, I was here to make money. I had developed a psychological dependence on purchasing these clown-themed trading cards from my local weed dispensary, and I needed a way to finance my purchasing them in bulk. It's all a speculative market; my investments will pay off ten years from now.

And maybe I experienced some kind of neurological re-wiring at this point in my life. What of it? It's not wrong for a man to

experience sexual awakening while being paid for his time in a 40-ton metal cylinder. Sometimes I would doze off during the night shifts and with my thoughts poisoned by thousands of illustrations of dope-smoking clowns, I would dream I was in a circus. My cannon would suddenly be painted a stimulating coat of red, white, and blue. I could see myself from the perspective of a stranger, and I too was painted brilliantly, with red in my cheeks like an orgasmic blush. I could see a sea of clowns surrounding me, caught in a rhythmic dance.

Most times I found myself in the circus, I would jolt awake to some loud factory sound ringing the whole cannon tube, but this one Tuesday night, last year in May, the entire factory was dead silent. Before long, I was back in the circus. As the clowns spun their circles around me and my cannon, I sensed something approaching. All of a sudden I felt a stern pressure on my iron hull, as the most muscular clown of them all had leaned on my cannon. He produced a blunt from thin air, took a long inhale of it, then flicked it onto my fuse. I heard that fire crackle and my muscles tightened for the blast. The clowns kept dancing and dancing and the big one wrapped his arm tight around the perimeter.

I woke up with semen in my pants. My boss, a particularly bulldog-adjacent man, was peering down the barrel with as much of his face as could fit. "We need to have a chat," he said, his speech half-obstructed by a cigar. I apologized about as much as a half-awake man with semen in his pants could from the inside of a cannon.

"We're letting you go."

I thought about a really topical joke I could've made, but instead I told him I understood and I walked home in the dark. It wasn't that funny anyway.

Introducing Tall Booth

Jupiter
How do I get down from here?

As students, staff, and alumni flood the Midway this Carnival, they'll notice the usual arrangement of booths, each with its own unique design. Navigating through the Midway, entranced with the artistry of Spring Carnival, they'll walk slowly into the shadow lurking at the back of the Midway. There, they'll find the newest addition to the Booth competition: Tall Booth.

The point of Tall Booth is not simply to build a sound structure with a nice exterior. Instead, the simple objective of Tall booth is height. Build the tallest booth imaginable. How tall? To space and beyond ideally.

According to the committee responsible for founding Tall Booth, building one requires creative thinking. As such, builders are actually encouraged not to complete the usually mandated BioRaft training for building booths as such training prohibits the flow of

ideas for extending the height of the booth. In observing the building of Tall Booths, reporters have noticed all manners of creative building methods. There were reporters on ladders stacked on ladders in order to reach the 9th or 10th stories of some booths. Or, 2 by 4s being used to cover the outside of booths after builders have run out of exterior ply.

Venturing inside these booths, many feature one singular ladder to access the various floors, much like the ladders mounted on the sides of wind turbines. Staring up, visitors of Tall Booths report seeing the structure sway side to side and groan under their own weight. Some argue that the constant movement of the booth interferes with playing the games. Tall Booth builders argue that it's part of the fun.

So, as you venture out on the Midway this spring, consider stopping by these marvels of jank engineering and experience Tall Booth!

On Pediatrics

Elliot Rice
Amateur Mathematician

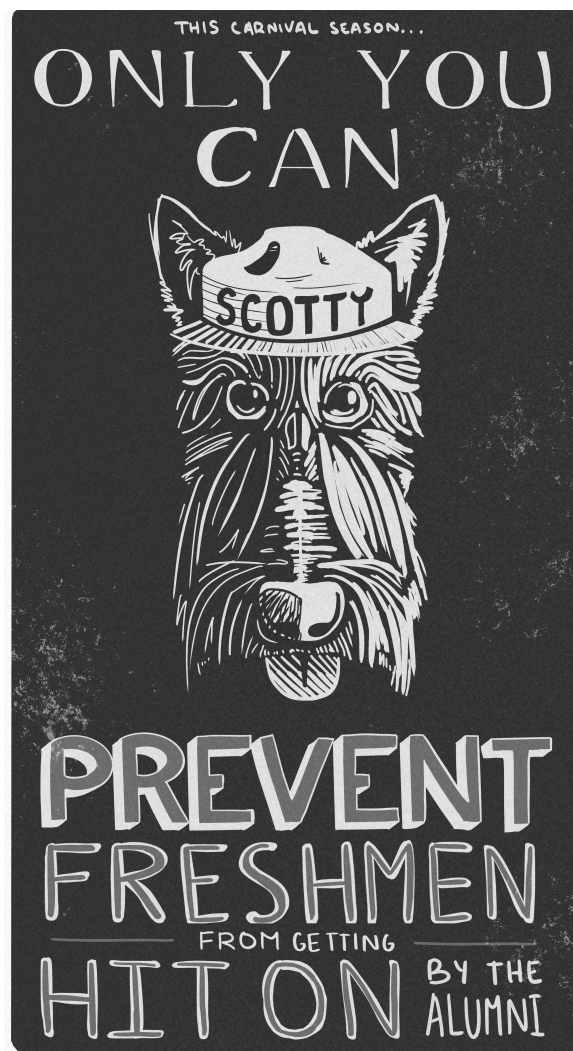
The p-adic numbers are an extension of the rational numbers $\mathbb{Q}$ which are distinct from the set of real numbers $\mathbb{R}$. They can be thought of somewhat similarly to numbers with bases that are not 10; however, at a fundamental level, they are not the same. The "p" in the term p-adic denotes a certain prime number, and there are different p-adic numbers for every prime. For example, one may talk about the 3-adic numbers or the 17-adic numbers. When we write a number in base-3, for example, we write from left as a decimal. For example, $\frac{1}{5}$ in base-3 can be written as 0.01210121. On the other hand, p-adic representations of rational numbers are written from right to left in the form of an infinite decimal expansion. So, the real rational number $\frac{1}{5}$ in 3-adic is written as ...121012102₃. These are almost inversions of each other, with one important difference, the "first" (rightmost) number in the 3-adic expansion is a 2, which breaks the pattern seen in the base-3 expansion. This is an application of the modulo function: let the rightmost digit be a_0 . We want a_0 such that $a_0 \equiv \frac{1}{5} \pmod{3}$.

This leads us to see that $1 \equiv 2a_0 \pmod{3}$, so $a_0 = 2$. Other than that, the pattern of numbers repeats similarly to the same rational number of base p, although this is an informal way of thinking. Formally, a p-adic number can be better conceptualized as the

power series $s = \sum_{i=k}^{\infty} a_i p^i$ where k is an integer, and a_i is an

integer between 0 and p. Although they may seem obscure or useless, the p-adic numbers have many uses not just in mathematics but also in quantum mechanics.

The reason this issue is so pressing today, however, is simple. What if the p-adic numbers were called the pediatric numbers, and only kids could use them? Wouldn't that be funny?



Don't Come Back

Bertie Wooster
Sick of your bullshit

It's Spring Carnival, meaning our campus is once again clogged with the shambling corpses of alumni who refuse to die with dignity. This is a group that includes you, probably, and if it doesn't, it will. Every April, you ooze back onto campus in your quarter-zips, grinning like dim-witted Golden Retrievers recalling where they buried a bone during the Obama Administration. "Wow, they haven't torn down Donner yet?" "I haven't painted the Fence since SAE held it for two weeks in the freezing cold." "I remember when Jim and I..." Shut the fuck up. No one cares.

We know you're not coming back because you care about us students. You are coming back because your marriage is collapsing in a Bay Area suburb and the last time you felt a spark of something more was when you got blackout drunk at Carnival and fingered someone on Flagstaff. Okay, whatever. Good for you. You've had your turn, built your buggy, kissed your sweetheart at the Fence, and got all your sepia-toned memories. That's sweet, I get it.

I'll put it gently, to avoid causing you a heart attack (and because my publisher is glaring at me to tone it down): those days are gone. You'll never get them back, no matter how hard you try. You cannot reconnect to the campus community by throwing your blood money at us.

We do not want your money or your tales of yore. We don't want to hear about how ReadMe was run by AB or how the Natrat used to be the peak of comedy. We don't give a flying fuck about how you used to make fun of the KGB, as if no one does anymore, or your shenanigans in the steam tunnels.

You will never absolve yourself of becoming the hollow, LinkedIn-poisoned ghoul you swore never to be. If, despite this warning, you still donate, we will spend your \$50 printing your name under the headline "Local Alumni Still Masturbates to Memories of Booth" and leave copies where your family can find them. We would do this regardless of whether or not you donate if only we had the printing budget. You have been warned.

CRYPTID CORNER

PRESENTED BY:
ISABELLE FLORENCE



SMILING MAN

I dated this guy for like a few weeks, I just didn't realize he was, you know, from the planet Lanulos in the galaxy of Genemedes. I guess it just never came up while we were getting to know each other over Hinge. In retrospect, I probably should have asked him why his age was set in the thousands. And yes, I don't set an upper age limit in preferences, I won't defend myself here, but if I were to defend myself for a moment, I would like to say that there is a nonzero chance of me meeting Liza Minnelli and us falling in love.

Regardless, a few ill-advised messages later, I was at cheap Italian restaurant with Indrid Cold, The Pale One. I liked him well enough, aside from that weird smile of his. I think that otherworldly entities who happen to enjoy smiling get a bad reputation from creepypastas, because that trope really was all the rage at that point in the internet's history. Just throw a big old grin on a creepy guy that does a creepy thing and call it a day. The creepy part of Jeff the Killer wasn't that he smiled, it was that he Jeff-the-Killed people.

Honestly, Indrid was a pretty upstanding guy. We had a pretty polite and mutual breakup because he claimed had to listen to a capella music covers of radio hits during sex and, as it turns out, I was just not yet at a point in my life where I could handle that. I hope he finds someone who can.

I did unfortunately contract Alien Herpes.

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CATHY DILDO

SHOW YOUR PITT SPIRIT!

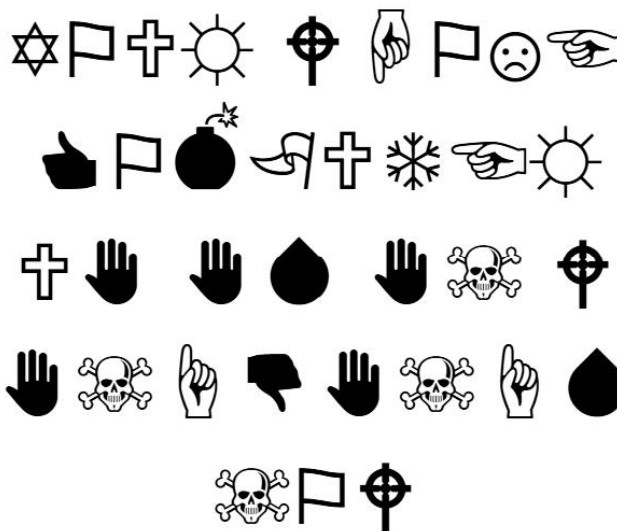
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